PCT BACKPACKING GEAR LIST

Please use this gear list for the following Shasta Mountain Guides programs:

- PCT Backpacking
- PCT Women's Backpacking

For your safety and comfort, please follow this list diligently. Every item on this list is required, unless clearly stated otherwise. Mountain weather is unpredictable with sun, wind, rain and snow possible , and temperatures that may range from 40°F to 95°F. Locally rentable items from The Fifth Season are marked with bold blue text*. Please call or email us with any questions about your gear. Selecting alpine mountaineering gear can be overwhelming, here are some tips from our guides:

- Versatility is the key to proper clothing and equipment. Think "light and simple" when packing. Avoid bringing doubles of similar layers. Your pack will weigh 25-45 lbs. depending on your "light and simple" gear choices.
- The rain jacket and pants function as both a waterproof and windproof layer. It is required during inclement weather.. A softshell jacket may be appropriate July-September if no precipitation is forecasted.
- The insulated jacket is HIGHLY RECOMMENDED for all trips. It is to be worn over your other clothing layers. It should be high loft and very warm yet compressible. Good examples include the Black Diamond Cold Forge Jacket, or the Outdoor Research Coldfront Down Hoodie. Light or moderately insulated jackets, akin to the Patagonia Micro Puff, are GENERALLY NOT sufficient.
- No Cotton. Cotton retains moisture and drains body heat when wet; this includes briefs/bras, etc. Moisture wicking layers like Capilene or Wool are best for mountain activities.
- Adequate footwear is required for backpacking. Sandals, light trail runners, etc. are not recommended
- Consider a thin, non-cushioned, well-fitted hiking sock to help reduce the risk of blisters and hotspots.

CLOTHING

	Item	Description	Qty.
⬜	Hiking Socks	Wool or Synthetic, lightweight	2-3 pairs
⬜	Underwear	Briefs and bras must be synthetic material	1-3 pairs
⬜	Base Layer Bottom	Wool or synthetic fabric. Light weight warmth.	1
⬜	Base Layer Top	Wool or synthetic Can be your Sun Hoody layer	1
⬜	Mid Layer Top	Midweight synthetic or wool sweater, jacket, or vest	1
⬜	Waterproof Pants	Uninsulated, lightweight hardshell, full-leg zip preferred.	1 pair
⬜	Waterproof Jacket	Uninsulated, lightweight hardshell	1
⬜	Insulated Jacket	Important! Down/synthetic. Medium/heavy weight warmth	1
⬜	Sun Hoody	(Highly recommended) with a hood or large collar	1
⬜	Light Softshell Pants	Medium weight fabric. Provides wind/water/abrasion resistance in snowy environments	1 pair
⬜	Hiking Shorts	(Optional) For the hike to basecamp ONLY	1 pair

⬜	Fleece or Wool Hat	Warm & covers ears, fits underneath climbing helmet	1
⬜	Brimmed Sun Hat	Baseball cap style, visor, or other	1
⬜	Buff	lightweight/breathable style, uninsulated	1
⬜	Light Weight Gloves	Softshell liner type glove	1 pair

EQUIPMENT

	Item	Description	Qty.
⬜	Backpacking Boots	Modern, well-fitted.	1 pair
⬜	Trekking/Ski poles*	With snow baskets, collapsible preferred	1 pair
⬜	60-75L Backpack*	65-80 Liter/5,000 cubic inches, internal frame	1
⬜	Sleeping Bag*	Synthetic or down, mummy style, rated to 20-30°F. If you're a cold sleeper, consider a rating of 10-20°F	1
⬜	Sleeping Pad*	Inflatable style and closed cell/z-fold style foam pads	2

PERSONAL/MISCELLANEOUS

	Item	Description	Qty.
⬜	Eating Utensils	Cup, bowl, spoon only	1 pair
⬜	Headlamp	With fresh batteries	1 pair
⬜	Sunglasses	Dark-lensed glacier or sport style, polarized preferred	1
⬜	Sunscreen and lip protection	30 SPF minimum	1
⬜	Personal Kit	Small quantity of toilet paper, towelettes, hygiene items, blister kit, personal medications, etc.	1pair
⬜	Garbage Bag	For packing out solid waste kits, aka “wag bags”	1
⬜	Camp Shoes	(Optional) very light shoes/sandals in mid/late summer	1
⬜	Earplugs	(Optional) We will be sharing tents on the mountain	1
⬜	Phone/Camera	Cell service is intermittent on the trail. Consider an extra battery.	1
⬜	Snacks/food	Consider light lunch-style food for non-climb days and snack-style food for the climb day. (See below)	Varied

EQUIPMENT PROVIDED BY SHASTA MOUNTAIN GUIDES

	Item	Description
⬜	Tents	We supply 1, 2, and 3-person backpacking tents
⬜	Main Meals (Dinner, Lunch Breakfast)	We provide all meals while in the backcountry. Meals are organic and delicious! Vegetarian, vegan, dairy free, and gluten are easily accommodated. Contact us if you have dietary needs.
⬜	All Passes and Permits	Required by the USFS, NPS, and/or USDA, depending on location
⬜	Friendly and professional Guides	

SNACK SUGGESTIONS

Snack examples include: Clif Bars, Shots, or Blocks; energy/candy bars; hard or gummy candy; dried fruit, nuts; jerky, cheese, salty trail mix, etc. Many like to supplement breakfast with additional protein like nuts, jerky, cheese, etc. depending on needs and preferences.